

Ἰδαῖος ὁ Ἱμεραῖος

Idaeus of Himera and the Presocratic Tradition in Sicily

eul_aid: czi

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἰωνική](#) [Ionic](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Συναγωγή](#) [Collection](#)
Affiliation: [Presocratic](#)

Idaeus of Himera was a philosopher from the 5th century BCE during the Classical period of ancient Greece. He lived in Himera, a Greek colony on the island of Sicily. According to the later historian Damascius, Idaeus was a follower of Pythagoreanism, a philosophical and religious school influential in southern Italy and Sicily at the time.

No writings by Idaeus survive. He is known only from a single report by Damascius, which states that Idaeus, along with another thinker, taught that the fundamental principles of the universe were a pair of opposites: the Limited and the Unlimited. This idea is a core part of early Pythagorean cosmology, which sought to explain reality through such opposing principles.

His historical importance is minimal but specific. He is a documented example of how Pythagorean ideas spread through the Greek colonies of the western Mediterranean. His near-total obscurity is also typical, illustrating how our knowledge of many early Greek thinkers depends entirely on brief mentions by later authors who compiled histories of philosophy.

Works (1)

- [Μαρτυρία](#) · [Testimony](#) · 1 passages

Other Presocratic Authors

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- [Ἀναξίμενης ὁ Μιλήσιος](#) · [Anaximenes of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀναξίμενους τοῦ Μιλήσιου Ἐπιστολαί \(Ψευδο-Ἀναξίμενης\)](#) · [Anaximenes-pseudo Miletus Letters](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρχέλαος ὁ Μιλήσιος ὁ Ἀθηναῖος](#) · [Archelaus of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- [Κλεόβουλος ὁ Λίνδιος](#) · [Cleobulus of Lindos I](#) · 1 work
- [Δημόκριτος ὁ Ἀβδηρίτης](#) · [Democritus of Abdera](#) · 2 works
- [Διογένης ὁ Ἀπολλωνιάτης](#) · [Diogenes of Apollonia](#) · 2 works
- [Ἐμπεδοκλῆς ὁ Ἀκραγαντίνος](#) · [Empedocles of Acragas](#) · 3 works
- [Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος](#) · [Heraclitus of Ephesus](#) · 2 works

- [Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Heraclitus of Ephesus II](#) · 1 work